



St Gerard's Parish Weekly Bulletin

16th August 2026



Welcome to Celebrate Today's Liturgy Mass Times

Saturday Vigil- 18.30

Sunday Mass—10.30

Monday—Liturgy of The Word 9.30

Tuesday Mass -9.30

Wednesday Mass- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Prayer Service- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Mass—19.30

Friday Mass - 9.30

Saturday Silent Meditation—9.30

Holy Days Vigil 7.30pm Morning 9:30

Reconciliation Saturday 17.30—18.15
otherwise by appointment with Priest

Baptisms 2nd and 4th Sundays—Baptism
Preparation course 5pm on 1st Monday of each
month for those wishing to have their child Baptised
in St Gerard's—ring Parish office to arrange both.

Priest Fr Patrick O'Keeffe CSsR ADM

Parish Office 028 90 774833
726 Antrim Road (office hrs M-F 9.30-1.30)

Email stgerards@downandconnor.org

Website stgerardsparish.org

Church Services: Our live streaming web
address has been updated. To access MCN
Media, please go to www.mcn.live on your web
browser. THE CHURCH WEBCAM CAN BE ACCESSED
VIA

mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey

(Playback available on **Recorded** services only -
Recording Requests can be made through Parish
office)

**For Anniversary Mass Intentions on preferred dates—
Please (if possible) make requests 3-4 weeks in advance*

The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
Creator of heaven and earth,
and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died and was buried;
he descended into hell;
on the third day
he rose again from the dead;
he ascended into heaven,
and is seated at the right hand of
God the Father almighty;
from there he will come to judge the
living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic Church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and life everlasting. Amen.

Prayer for Vocations

Loving and Generous God,
it is You who call us by name and ask us to follow you.
Help us to grow in the Love and service of our Church
as we experience it today.
Give us the energy and courage of Your Spirit to shape its future.
Grant us faith-filled leaders who will embrace Christ's Mission
of love and justice.
Bless the Church by raising up dedicated and generous leaders
from our families and friends who will serve Your people
as Sisters, Priests, Brothers, Permanent Deacons
and Lay Ministers.
Inspire us to know You better and open our hearts to
hear Your call.
We ask this through Christ our Lord. Amen

22nd/23rd August—Nicola Fitzpatrick will come along to talk to us
about SERVE—2026 Flip Flop Appeal—support enables SERVE to
sustain vital projects that create opportunities for vulnerable
communities in the Global South. This annual initiative raises
awareness and funds to support employment opportunities for
women and young people in communities across Africa and Asia.

Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August
2026 - Legion of Mary—'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith
and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass,
confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary
headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin
7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults
from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 29 August
from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterward. Tickets cost €20 and
can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the
Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass
on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry City**.
The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal
McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk
for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.
For more information and booking details, please
email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

St Joseph Men's Camino Every Camino changes us in ways we don't
expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland
on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the
Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass,
Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with
after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+.
Cost: €65 (student €55).
Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events.
Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

The Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick, invite you to a
special screening of **Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic** at Newcastle
Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle, on Friday
4th September at 7.00pm. Matt Talbot's remarkable true story
of faith, struggle, addiction and redemption continues to inspire
people throughout the world and offers a powerful message of hope
to those affected by addiction and their families. The evening will also
feature guest speaker Michael Murphy. Admission is free, with a
suggested donation of £3 towards costs. Tea and coffee will be served
following the screening. Everyone is very welcome

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential
Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the
"Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare.
Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication,
renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.
www.marriageencounter.ie

Thank you all for all your kind and generous donations and support
for St Gerard's Parish, and thank you for all donations that have
gone through the Digital Collection Plate at the back of the church.
If you would like to donate via standing order, please contact the
Parish office for a form.
August 2nd Collections –2nd –St Gerard's Community;
9th Building Fund ; 16th Dioc Cathedral Fund

PASTORAL COMMUNITY

HOLY FAMILY PARISH
CLERGY
Very Rev. Michael Spence PP
Rev. John O'Lavery CC
Rev. Brendan Dowd Deacon
Mass Times
HOLY FAMILY CHURCH,
14 Newington Avenue, Belfast, BT15 2HP
Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 10.30am
Holydays: 9.15am
Weekdays: Mon–Wed 9.15am
Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Wed at 9.15am
First Saturday Devotions: First Saturday of the month at 10am
ST THERÈSE OF LISIEUX CHURCH,
71 Somerton Road, Belfast, BT15 4DE
Sunday: 9am & 12pm
Holydays: 7pm Vigil & 10am
Weekdays: Thurs–Sat 10am
Eucharistic Adoration: Mon–Sat, 10am–4pm

ST. PATRICK'S PARISH
CLERGY
Very Rev. Francis O'Brien PP
Mass Times
ST PATRICK'S CHURCH
199 Donegall St Belfast BT1 2FL
Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 9am, 11am & 6pm
Holydays: Please check parish website and Facebook
Weekdays: Tues, Wed, Thurs 10am
Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help
every Wednesday at 10am
Novena in honour of St. Anthony and Blessing with the relic of
St Anthony of Padua every Tuesday at 10am

Anam Cara is very pleased to announce our
first **Bereavement Information Evening** especially dedicated
to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our
commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a
child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the
entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of
that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose
child or children have died, regardless of the age of their
child, circumstances of their death, or time since
bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement
Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. This
event will take place online on **Tuesday 15 September at
7pm**. We are joined by an exceptional panel of local
organisations and experts in sibling bereavement. **Michelle
Hartnett** is a senior play therapist, systemic practitioner, and
bereavement specialist currently working with **LauraLynn**,
Ireland's Children's Hospice, with over 15 years' experience
supporting families through serious illness, grief, and loss.
Michelle holds an MSc in Systemic Therapy and an MSc in
Bereavement Studies, and is a Grief Consultant with
Middlesex University. She also holds a postgraduate
certificate and diploma in Play Therapy from NUI
Galway. **Anna May** is founder of **The Student Grief
Network** and Executive Head of Grief Programmes at Kaplan
International. She lost her brother as a child and her dad as a
young adult, and is passionate about improving the support
that people get following a bereavement. Anna is also a
writer and artist, interested in how creativity can help us
explore difficult human experiences and build more
connected ways of living. We are also joined by **Childhood
Cancer Ireland**, **Jacinta's Smile**, and **Rainbows**. In the world
of grief and loss, siblings, especially adult siblings, are often
called 'forgotten mourners.' Siblings face not only their own
loss, but often the loss of their parents and families as they
knew them, the loss of the only person who was present of
their whole life, and often the loss of a close friend.
We believe this is why it is essential to begin forming an
all-island bereavement support for adult siblings facing all
kinds of sibling loss.

May They Rest In Peace

Recently Deceased John Kelly, Geraldine McDonald Graham

Months Mind

Anniversaries Joseph Smyth, Geraldine McDonnell, Margaret O'Neill, Joseph McAufield,
Mona McKillop, Kathleen McKillop